15.12 Preterm Labor*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I have regular tightening at 30 weeks." **Objective** • Contractions every 5 minutes • Cervical change	**ACTUAL** Labor pain related to preterm uterine contractions as evidenced by regular contractions.	• Copes with contractions during treatment.	• Give tocolytics as prescribed. • Offer comfort measures; lie her on her left side. • Record how often contractions come.	• Considered met when she is coping.
Subjective • "It is too early for my baby." **Objective** • Anxious • Tearful	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety related to threatened preterm birth as evidenced by worry.	• Less anxious.	• Explain the plan of care. • Arrange a visit from the neonatal team. • Let a support person stay.	• Goal reached when she is calmer.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Preterm pregnancy • Cervical change	**RISK** Risk for impaired maternal-fetal dyad as evidenced by risk factors: preterm labor.	• Preparation for preterm birth complete.	• Give antenatal corticosteroids as prescribed. • Give magnesium sulfate for fetal neuroprotection as prescribed. • Follow the fetal heart. • Inform the neonatal unit.	• Met when preparation is complete.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [47], [72], [142]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.